

EXPRESSIVE READING

Mr. George Mueller

When the families returned from church, Mrs. Virtueson placed a lovely tablecloth on the dining room table, and Mrs. Willing set out eight dinner plates - one plate for each person.

After the food was brought to the table, the family sat down. "What a lovely meal God has provided," said Mr. Virtueson. "Grandpa, will you say the blessing?"

Grandpa thanked the Lord for all He had provided. Then the family enjoyed fellowship as they ate. At one point Grandpa Virtueson said, "You know Brother Willing, I told the Lord when I was just a boy that I would be willing to be a foreign missionary. God did not call me to go to a faraway land, however. Even though I am getting old now, I would still go today if He should want me to go."

It's interesting that you should say that, Grandpa Virtueson," said Mr. Willing. Surely you have read about Mr. George Mueller? Mr. George Mueller lived in Germany. He told the Lord when he was a young man that he would go to a land like China that was thousands of miles, or kilometers, away. He really hoped God would call him to China or some land far away from Germany. However, God used Mr. Mueller for many years in the nearby country of England. Then when he was much older, God did let him travel to different mission fields of the world."

"Mr. Mueller was about 20 years old when he entered a university in Germany," said Mr. Willing. "He was not a Christian then, but one day a university friend asked him to attend a prayer meeting.

"At the prayer meeting, Mr. Mueller saw something that greatly shocked him. When it was time to pray, the man who was asked to lead in prayer got down on his knees. He also bowed his head as he prayed. Young Mr. Mueller had never seen anyone kneel and bow his head when he prayed. It was a shock. Here was someone who knew God was greater

than himself. At that prayer meeting, for the first time in his life, Mr. Mueller saw someone bow his head and kneel in prayer.

"As he was leaving the prayer meeting, he said to his friend, 'I was shocked to see that man get down on his knees! Why did he kneel to pray?' His friend had no answer.

"Although Mr. Mueller was shocked to see the young man kneel and bow his head to pray, God was doing something in Mr. Mueller's heart. He knew God was real, and he knew God was much greater than he was. That night he determined that more than anything else, he must know the living God. Later in his room, Mr. Mueller got down on his knees. As he kneeled and bowed his head, he asked God to save him, and a wonderful thing happen. The Lord Jesus Christ came into Mr. Mueller's life!"

"After Mr. Mueller was saved, his life changed," said Mr. Willing. People at the university could see the change. God became very real to Mr. Mueller, and he thought God must want him to become a foreign missionary.

"Mr. Mueller also believed he could talk to God about everything. One morning while eating breakfast in his room, he bowed his head and prayed, 'Oh, God, I need help. I owe money for rent. I owe for the rest of the year's schooling, and I owe for my school books. But I have faith to believe You will send the help I need. I will just wait on You. In Jesus' name I ask You. Amen.'

"A short time later there was a knock at the door. When Mr. Mueller answered the knock, two men were standing outside. One of the men was a teacher at the university, and the other was a teacher from America. They had come knocking on Mr. Mueller's door to ask him to teach the American teacher and three other friends the German language.

"Mr. Mueller knew that by teaching German he could earn money to pay the bills he owed. From that day on, Mr. George Mueller began to take all his needs to the Lord and trust Him to meet them."